



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Corporate Use of Social Media Policy and Guidelines

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1.0 Introduction

Social media is being used more and more by law enforcement agencies worldwide not only as a means of improving external communication but also as an aid to crime solving. These media forms are used to combat internet related crimes and have been found to be useful in, solving crimes that are happening in communities, promoting safety, highlighting police/citizens activities and events and also soliciting the public's assistance in locating missing persons and properties. Despite the many positives associated with social media, if improperly used, both personal and organisational embarrassment could result.

The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) recognizes the important role that social media play. Hence the need to educate and inform members about the positive and negative outcomes that are involved in the usage of this technological tool. Significant too is the need to standardize the methodologies in the dissemination of information using this medium.

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of this document is to:

2.1 outline the JCF's policy on the corporate use of social media which includes the:

- 2.1.1 creation, management, assessment and decommissioning of official JCF social media sites;
- 2.1.2 standards required of material/information posted by sworn and unsworn employees formally representing the police force on the JCF's social media sites;
- 2.1.3 standards required of members of the public who wish to contribute to official JCF social media sites.

2.2 set guidelines to ensure the safe, accurate and credible exchange of communication between the police force and the public when using social media.

3.0 Scope

This policy and guidelines on the JCF Use of Social Media apply to all sworn and unsworn members of the Force. It applies to all official communication on social media sites by the JCF and covers the access to and official use of social media for disseminating information to, or requesting information from the public. This policy does not apply to the use or creation of social media sites.

4.0 Abbreviation

CCN	Constabulary Communications Network
JCF	Jamaica Constabulary Force
LAC	Local Area Commanders

5.0 Definition

5.1. Social Media Social media are groups of web-based applications that enable the creation and exchange of user generated content. Social media occur in a variety of formats including chat rooms, weblogs, social blogs, wikis, micro-blogging, internet fora, podcasts, pictures, videos and rating and social book marking. Examples of social media include, but are not limited to Facebook, LinkedIn, Myspace, YouTube, Flickr and Twitter.

6.0 Responsibilities

- 6.1 The Constabulary Communications Network (CCN) is responsible for all official corporate JCF social media sites set up for the exchange of information between the police and the public.
- 6.2 The Commanding officer of a Local Area/formation is responsible for the operation and the content of that Local Area Commander's (LAC) Facebook site. He or she may delegate this responsibility as deemed appropriate to other officers of the Command but shall remain accountable
- 6.3 The Superintendent of Police in-charge Information and Communication Technology Division (ICTD) is responsible for the management and or decommissioning of JCF corporate media sites (login, access, shutdown ect.)
- 6.4 A Social Media moderator shall be appointed by the Director CCN or in the case of a Formation, the formation's commander, and shall be responsible to monitor the JCF social media sites to ensure that on-line postings placed on official JCF social media sites are relevant, non-threatening, respectful of the views of other contributors, and are not insulting, obscene or defamatory.

7.0 Policy Statements

It is the policy of the JCF that:

- 7.1. The JCF shall maintain a presence on social media which will allow the Force to bypass the traditional media and deliver messages directly to the public
- 7.2. Social media accounts set up for corporate use shall be scrupulously managed by the CCN and or the respective formation commander to ensure optimization of the opportunities that social media provides, while maintaining the credibility, appropriateness and accuracy/correctness of the content of each post, and the ethics and integrity of JCF
- 7.3. Members authorized to publicly represent the force on social media sites shall not use these sites for posting material that:
 - 7.3.1. is offensive or obscene, such as material of a sexual/pornographic nature (regardless of the format or how mild or whether recipients are offended or not);
 - 7.3.2. could reasonably discriminate against, intimidate, vilify or defame individuals, groups or entities, including the Police Service, its employees and other government agencies;
 - 7.3.3. endorses a commercial or profit making activity;
 - 7.3.4. is chain, junk or spam mail;
 - 7.3.5. is inappropriate and or includes rude jokes and;
 - 7.3.6. conflicts with the acceptable User Standards at item **8:13**.

8.0 Guidelines

8.1. SOCIAL MEDIA AND THE POLICE FORCE

8.1.1 Police use of the Social Media

Social Media sites such as Facebook, You Tube and Twitter are becoming an increasingly important public information communication tool for the Police Service. Social media allows the Police Force to bypass the traditional media and deliver messages directly to the public. It allows for direct two way conversation with the community which enhances police citizen's public relation.

8.1.2 Official Use

JCF accounts on Social Media sites will be used for the purposes of official and overt communication by members of the JCF and its auxiliaries in disseminating information to, or requesting information from the public.

8.1.3 Personal Use

The *Personal Use of Social Media Policy & Guidelines* is a separate complimentary policy document that sets out standards that must be followed when members of the JCF and its auxiliaries use the social media in a private capacity. The policy also provides guidelines to help employees protect their safety, privacy and career.

8.1.4 Compliance

All employees are required to comply with this policy. Breaches of the Official Police Use of Social Media Policy may result in managerial action, including withdrawal of the right to represent the Police Service online, loss of confidence or dismissal, and/or criminal or civil sanctions.

8.2 CORPORATE SOCIAL MEDIA SITES

8.2.1 YouTube, Facebook and Twitter

To maximise the opportunities that social media provide, the Police Service have established Corporate Facebook, YouTube, Twitter sites to increase the agency's ability to engage with the community.

8.2.1.1 YouTube

The JCF YouTube channel will display and provide new videos each month. Content will be added to the site for public viewings on an ongoing basis. These videos are to include CCTV footage of missing and wanted persons, arrests or search warrants filmed in-house by the CCN, appeals for assistance, crime prevention advice and police advertising campaigns. It is expected that valuable information on the names and whereabouts of wanted persons will be passed on to investigators by community members via the YouTube channel after viewing posted CCTV footage.

8.2.1.2 Facebook

Facebook provides the ability to deliver messages directly to the public and to conduct two way conversations, enabling the Police Force to receive and answer questions. Facebook is also another

avenue for the public to give compliments, make complaints and to report crime. The Police Force Facebook page will also include topics pertaining to recruitment, video packages and media releases

8.2.1.3 Twitter

The Police Twitter feed is used to relay simple messages and to provide links to the police YouTube channel and website to facilitate public access to our videos, images and media releases. The multiplier effect of people 're-tweeting' police messages makes twitter a very powerful tool.

8.3 REPRESENTING THE POLICE FORCE ON-LINE

8.3.1 Authorization

8.3.1.1 Authorization to Represent

Authorisation from the Director, JCF Corporate Communications Network (CCN), is required for the Police Service employees to represent the department:

- i. On the official corporate police social media sites,
- ii. On non-police social media sites; and
- iii. Broadcast on behalf of the JCF on other social media sites not used by the JCF

8.3.1.2 Authorisation can be time limited or can be revoked at any time by the Director, JCF Corporate Communications. For authorisation to represent the JCF officially on recommended social media sites, see **section 8.4**

8.3.2 Rules for Representing

8.3.2.1 Rules for representing On-line

If authorised to add or amend content on any JCF Social Media site, or if authorised to comment on-line or non-police social media sites on behalf of the Police Force, employees are required to:

- i. ensure that any content they publish is credible, factual, accurate and complies with relevant Police Force policies, particularly those relating to confidentiality, disclosure and ethics;

- ii. ensure they are not the first to make a police announcement unless they have received the appropriate approvals in accordance with the JCF Media Policy for releasing information to the public;
- iii. ensure they do not commit the Police Service or the Government to any action or initiative unless they have authority to do so;
- iii. ensure they do not disclose official information (whether confidential or not) unless authorised to do so.
- iv. ensure they are not culpable for the disclosure of personal information of other individuals on social media sites unless it a matter being investigated and the information is pertinent to the arrest of an accused.eg. description and particulars of the accused.
- v. only offer advice, support or comment on topics that fall within their area of responsibility/expertise. For other matters, obtain advice from or refer to the relevant topic expert or corporate spokesperson;
- vi. be objective and impartial. Avoid personal comment on any political issue that could be interpreted as advocacy for or criticism of a political decision, value, or policy or views that expresses any favour for one political party over the other.;
- vii. avoid any statement or comment that might bring the Police Service into disrepute;
- viii. avoid any statement or comment that could be perceived as criticising the practices of the Police Service and other departments within the organization or the Government;
- ix. avoid publishing material that could lead to criminal penalty or civil liability;
- x. be polite and respectful of all individuals and communities on-line, even in times of heated discussion and debate;

- xi. avoid antagonistic, insensitive, condescending or other socially offensive language;
- xii. use non-discriminatory language, taking care not to cause contention or offence to any section of the community;
- xiii. avoid using abbreviations, jargon, colloquialisms, clichés or ambiguous, technical or abstract terms; xv. respect the laws covering copyright, privacy, libel, defamation and the protection of intellectual property; xvi. have the permission of colleagues before writing about or posting images of them;
- xiv. Let people know who you are and what you want to achieve. You should disclose your position as a representative of the department, unless there are exceptional circumstances such as a potential threat to personal security.

8.3.3 Writing Style

The tone and style used in social media is less formal than in other media such as the corporate website or brochures. However, police social media sites or postings are still representative of the Police Service, and great care should be exercised in verbal expressions. So be careful of language, spelling and grammar. All writing for the Police Service social media sites should be simple, comprehensible, free from police jargon and comply with the Police Service policies and Guidelines.

8.3.4 Improper Use

Employees authorized to publicly represent the force on social media sites must not use these sites for posting material that:

- i. is offensive or obscene, such as material of a sexual/pornographic nature (regardless of the format or how mild or whether recipients are offended or not);
- ii. could reasonably discriminate against, intimidate, vilify or defame individuals, groups or entities, including the Police Service, its employees and other government agencies;
- iii. endorses a commercial or profit making activity;

- iv. is chain, junk or spam mail;
- v. is inappropriate and or includes rude jokes and;
- vi. inflicts with the acceptable User Standards at 8.3 below.

8.4 APPROVAL OF OFFICIAL POLICE SITES

8.4.1 The Approval Process for Divisional Sites

8.4.1.1 All proposals for significant social media activities such as;
(a) creating a new corporate social media site, (b) creating a site for a JCF formation such as a dedicated Facebook site for Area/Branch Command, Divisional or specialist formation, or (c) holding a major campaign or activity on an existing social media site, must be approved by the:

- i. The respective Commanding Officer (CO)
- ii. Relevant Assistant Commissioner/ Director or equivalent, and
- iii. Commissioner of Police, following assessment by the Director Corporate Communications.

8.4.1.2 All proposals for posting on the JCF social media must include the following details:

- i. The specific objectives of the activity;
- ii. The target audience;
- iii. The type of social media tool (Facebook, Twitter, You Tube etc) chosen;
- iv. What type of content is proposed and in what kinds of media (text, videos, images, audio).
- v. Provide information to be posted to the site/activity;
- vi. How will end users (eg members of the public) be able to contribute to the site, if relevant;
- vii. Plans for sustained content update and feedback. Sufficient resources must be available to ensure continual updating and moderating;
- viii. What is the cost to the Police Force (money and time) in setting up and ongoing management of the site or activity?
What is the funding source and has the funding been approved;
- ix. What risks have been identified in running this site, and what plans have been put in place to mitigate the risks;
- x. Which positions and persons will be responsible for the:

- a. Implementation and management of the activity including performance of the site or activity against the objectives,
 - b. Administration and moderation of activity on police site,
 - c. Provision and approval of content
 - d. Records management.
- xi. Evaluation and reporting-how will the activity will be measured against its objectives. What methods, qualitative and/ or quantitative, will be used to assess performance? When will the evaluation occur?

8.5 MANAGEMENT OF DIVISIONAL/ DEPARTMENT POSTINGS TO POLICE SOCIAL MEDIA SITES

8.5.1 Site Accountability

The approval of all significant social media activities, including social media sites, is ultimately the responsibility of the hosting Commander. For example, the Superintendent of a Local Area is responsible for the operation and the content of that Local Area Commander's (LAC) Facebook site. The Commander/Director of the JCF Corporate Communication may delegate this responsibility as deemed appropriate to other officers of the Command. Roles that may be delegated include responsibility for:

- i. Implementation and management of the activity, including performance against the objectives set out in the approval document;
- ii. Administration and modification of the activity or site; (3) Approval of content to be posted on site
- iii. Records management of the site.

8.5.2 Administrators

Administration of sites must be undertaken by the Constabulary Communication Unit and other employees who have been given permission to post activities on these sites. (Facebook, Twitter, and YouTube etc.)

8.5.3 Employees Posting to Site

The hosting formation Commander, or designate, is responsible for granting approval for Police Force employees to post information to the

formation activity or site. Staff given approval to post to the social media activity or site must:

- i. be competent in the area of expertise they will be approved to post on;
- ii. understand the requirements on the public release of information set out in the JCF Media Policy and the Code of Conduct and Ethic and;
- iii. understand the requirements/responsibilities in representing the JCF on these media sites as set out in this policy, especially at **section 8.3.4**

8.5.4 Approval of Content

8.5.4.1 Commanders or the delegated officers must only approve for publication on their Command's social media site or activity information which is operationally relevant to the functions of their Command, consistent with the content restrictions set out in **section 8.3.4** of this policy and the JCF Media policy.

8.5.4.2 Commanders or delegates must assess the security risk involved in publishing information on a social media site before granting approval, given that once posted on-line, it cannot be withdrawn, even if deleted.

8.5.4.3 All content must be factual, presented in a neutral or positive tone, and represent the official agency policy or position. The site content must not reflect personal opinions, particularly on official policy or practices. The key rule of assessing content is that the site or activity should not contain anything that the approving officer would not be comfortable with if published in a newspaper, or if said in public by a Police Officer in full uniform.

8.5.4.4 Do not approve any content that discloses personal information unless it can be justified that the information is being published for legitimate operational and/or law enforcement functions.

8.5.4.5 Approval for the posting of any information on a particular command site should be sought and obtained from the appropriate Commander(s), Corporate Communication Director or his/her designate.

8.6 MANAGEMENT OF CORPORATE SOCIAL MEDIA SITES

8.6.1 Management of Police Social Media Sites

8.6.1.1 The Constabulary Communications Network (CCN) is responsible for all official corporate Police Service social

media sites set up for the exchange of information between the police and the public.

8.6.1.2 The JCF Information and Communication Technology Division (ICTD) is responsible for the management and or decommissioning of JCF corporate media sites. The Digital Media Coordinator, CCN is responsible for maintaining the corporate social media sites, including the archiving of relevant material from the sites.

8.6.2 Posting Access to the Police Corporate Social Media Sites

8.6.2.1 Official postings of the Police Service corporate social media sites are primarily the responsibility of the JCF Director Corporate Communications; in particular the Digital Media Coordinator, Constabulary Communication Network and Police Force computer centre. CCN staff may also liaise with subject experts, corporate spokespersons or Commands to obtain information for posting, or to answer questions or clarify information posted by members of the public.

8.6.2.1 The Director Corporate Communications can grant access to other members of the Police Service to assist with administration of corporate police social media sites or to post content onto the sites.

8.6.3 Corporate Communications Network Assistance

8.6.3.1 Each Formation with a social media site is responsible for establishing, managing, and publishing, updating and moderating their site. The CCN and ICTD can support Commands with their social media sites by:

- i. assisting in setting up the site;
- ii. providing on-site training to nominated administrators and;
- iii. providing on-going telephone support;

8.6.3.2 The CCN will from time to time monitor the content of Command social media sites to:

- i. Proactively contact the site administrator to offer assistance;
- ii. Help ensure the messages being conveyed are consistent with corporate priorities, policies and decisions;

- iii. Help ensure adherence to the Official Police Use of Social Media Policy.

8.6.3.3 The CCN can advise and assist, or if required, direct Commands to modify or remove social media content that contravenes JCF policies such as the official Police Use of Social Media Policy, the JCF Media Policy, and the Code of Conduct and Ethics.

8.7 SOCIAL MEDIA SITES CONTENT

8.7.1 Suggested Topics

To assist employees in identifying appropriate content for posting to Police Service social media sites, the following topics are recommended:

8.7.1.1 Corporate Information

Media releases issued by the CCN and information on the Police Service website, are options from which content for police social media sites may be selected. These two sources contain information that is already corporately endorsed for public distribution.

8.7.1.2 Command Information

Individual commands will have information and topics that are relevant to their areas of expertise or geographic location. Where possible, information relevant to the local community or a specific target audience, and may also call to action i.e. please report advice that is applicable to the average person, same should be made available at the most convenient time.

8.7.1.3 Corporate or Command Campaigns

Promote relevant campaigns such as Police Career Day, traffic operations, and National campaigns on mobile phones and driving, or missing persons that are being hosted by the organization or individual Commands. Also these media may be used to encourage people to consider a career in the Police Force.

8.7.1.4 Crimes

Suggested crime related topics include:

- a. police most wanted, divisional top twelve;
- b. public enemy number one;
- c. curfews and cordon & search information;
- d. persons wanted for questioning;
- e. successes- arrests by the host Command, or by other sections of the Police Force or other law enforcement agencies;
- f. crime hotspots and what police are doing to address these locations and;
- g. Victim alert – tips on reducing the citizens’ vulnerability to becoming a victim of preventable crimes (e.g. stalkers or purse snatchers).

8.7.1.5 Appeal to users

Direct requests for information from the general public or a specific group, including:

- i. missing persons and property;
- ii. cold case appeals relevant to the Area or local Divisional Command;
- iii. wanted persons and;
- iv. witnesses

8.7.1.6 Emergencies

Provide information on emergencies that could impact on members of the community. For example, provide information on floods, bushfires, dangling high tension wires, blackouts, road closures or delays and suggested alternate route(s). Provide warnings, relevant contact numbers for further information and suggestions or information that may help residents make decisions that will help them to manage or avoid the problems associated with such incidents.

8.7.1.7 Events

Provide information on major events that could impact on the community such as music festivals, sporting events or fetes. Provide advice on potential traffic issues, crowd management, and requirements to host events, crime prevention and personal safety. Major events include:

- i. seasonal events such as summer and beach safety, New Year's Eve and Christmas fireworks information Day;
- ii. promotion of events organised by the host command or the Police Force such as a shopping centre exhibit or station open day, or Police Careers Day;
- iii. promotion of the Police Service or Command stand at events such as a local show and;
- iv. Community Safety, Community Based Policing local Committee Meetings- upcoming meetings and the outcomes from previous meetings;
- v. Requirements to host events.

8.7.1.8 Safety and Security

Proactive community safety and security messages, consistent with the position of the Corporate Spokesperson, if relevant:

- i. Community safety- promoting responsible behaviour in connection with alcohol, road safety, school safety, outdoor venues and licensed premises (parks, beaches, pubs and clubs)
- ii. Crime prevention- personal security, home security, vehicle security, business activity and fraud prevention.

8.7.1.9 General Interest

Other general information such as:

- i. good work by members of the command or Police Force in raising money for a charity;
- ii. sporting success by a command member or team;
- iii. Major Crimes quarterly update
- iv. Police Citizens Interaction Policy and other relevant guidelines and;
- v. Awards given to police or emergency service employees or members of the public (eg local recipients of bravery awards).

8.8 CONTENT MANAGEMENT

8.8.1 Postings

The following guideline is relevant to the postings to the JCF social media pages:

8.8.1.1 Keep postings timely, focusing on issues of relevance today or of events coming up soon.

8.8.1.2 Try and post regularly, mix up posts to provide varied and interesting content i.e. appeal for information followed by a crime prevention tip.

8.8.1.2 make the posts shared, be ones to enable users to spread police information into the community, for example; by providing options to post links to Twitter or Facebook.

8.8.1.3 Ensure posts are consistent with the corporate view i.e., that of the corporate communication spokesperson and the High Command.

8.8.2 Images of Wanted Persons or Missing Persons

8.8.2.1 If posting photo(s) of wanted person(s) or missing person(s), monitor the post carefully to ensure that comments do not contain information that may be defamatory or prejudicial to the investigative process or any future court proceedings.

8.8.2.2 It is important that the photo(s) and the text(s) are removed immediately from the sites (e.g. from the Facebook Wall and photo gallery) once the Wanted Person is caught or the Missing Person found.

8.8.3 Responding to Questions

When responding to a question posed on a site or activity, it is recommended that a link be provided to the JCF's or other relevant government agency's website. For example, for questions regarding legislation, reference should be made to the relevant Act on the Legislation (JIS/MoJ link etc) via a link. This option avoids inconsistencies between comments and government policies and legislations.

8.8.4 Appealing for Information

8.8.4.1 When appealing for information, encourage the public to report all information directly to the local Police Station, 311, 119 or Crime Stop.

- 8.8.4.2 Members of the public should be discouraged from posting information about potential Wanted Person(s) or details of crime on a social media site such as Facebook Wall, as this could be prejudicial, defamatory or incorrect.
- 8.8.4.3 Members of the public will post such information from time to time. When this occurs the information should be captured and removed from the site and the author encouraged to contact the police directly with any further information.

8.8.5 Advertising and Sponsorship

- 8.8.5.1 Advertising or sponsorship is not permitted on JCF social media sites unless authorised by the High Command or management board in special circumstances. The JCF does not sponsor or endorse products or services from external persons or organization.
- 8.8.5.2 A company or individual sponsors of an approved police activity or program may be acknowledged on a police social media site. The level of acknowledgement must be commensurate with the value of the sponsorship, as specified in the media Policy. Any reference to a sponsor should acknowledge the sponsor without endorsing the sponsor or any product.
- 8.8.5.2 While a sponsor's name may be acknowledged, there must be no link to a sponsor's internet or social media site unless approved by the Director, Corporate Communications Network.

8.8.6 Files, Formats and Links

- 8.8.6.1 Multimedia files such as .jpeg, .wmv, and .mpg files may be posted for downloading. However, where possible, links should be provided to ensure compatibility and ease of both downloading and printing.
- 8.8.6.2 When linking to another site, priority should be given to the JCF website or other relevant government agency websites, such as the JIS. Checks should be made with the Digital Media Coordinator, CCN, to link non-government websites. Care should be exercised that posting such links is not seen as an endorsement or sponsorship of this particular website. See **section 8.8.7** for more information.

8.8.7 External Links

8.8.7.1 The Police Service must be careful when determining the use of certain external link to a site or directory (e.g. drugs, family welfare). Some sites may carry different, even conflicting advice from the JCF's mandate and core principles and which has the potential to cause embarrassment to the Police Service. This is particularly the case with private sector organizations whose operations, standards and attitudes may not reflect those of the JCF and its auxiliaries.

8.8.7.2 Additionally, the Police Service may be legally liable for the re-publication of any defamatory material published via linking it to a police social media site, as if the Police Force were the original publisher.

8.8.7.3 Only links with specific relevance to Police Service Strategic Priorities, initiatives and operations may be listed, or those of other government departments and agencies.

8.8.7.4 Any links provided to another site must be closely monitored as part of the moderation process and the links removed or amended as appropriate.

8.8.7.5 It is recommended that the following disclaimer be displayed prominently on the official JCF social media sites:

“Third party sites or profiles linked to the site are not controlled, maintained or endorsed by the JCF (except for our own sites). To the extent permitted by law, the JCF is not responsible or liable for any content posted on or uploaded to this site by a user or any content on third party sites linked to this site.

This disclaimer may be revised from time to time, as appropriate, with the approval of the JCF Counsel.

8.9 ACCESSIBILITY

Social media sites or activities need to ensure that their content is available to the widest possible audience, including readers using assistive technology or accessibility features. Accessibility risks can be mitigated by the following standards procedures and suggestions outlined:

8.9.1 Text

Text options include:

- i. use of simple text;
- ii. avoid jargon;
- iii. use colour combinations that are easy to read and;
- iv. Teletype (TTY) numbers

8.9.2 Photographs

Name the photo after the description before uploading it to a social media site. Write text captions and descriptions where these fields are available. However, it is important not to name photographs of wanted persons.

8.9.3 PDF

Try to ensure documents are in compliance with source format before converting to PDF. Use formatting such as a header when applicable. Embed hyperlinks within the anchor text rather than supplying the physical URL to the right of the anchor text.

8.10 POLICE INVESTIGATIONS

8.10.1 Social Media Sites and Investigations

The CCN develops media and communications strategies and policies to assist a variety of policing situations, ranging from police investigations to the management of major incidents. Media and communications strategies can include both traditional and social media.

- 8.10.2** Contact the CCN to determine if your investigation or other law enforcement activity can be assisted by a Media or Communications strategy.

8.10.1 Images and Investigations

8.10.1.1 The release of photographic images or video recordings on Police social media sites can be a powerful investigative tool for:

- i. identifying Wanted Persons;
- ii. finding a Missing Persons or;
- iii. creating more community interest, resulting in the message getting to a wider cross-section of the public.

For example, in one case, within one hour of receipt of video images from detectives investigating a murder, the video was edited by the CCN, reviewed by the JCF Counsels and uploaded to the Police YouTube site. A link to the video from the Police Twitter site was also created. A number of viewers contacted police via the comment section on YouTube to provide detailed information identifying people depicted in the video. These comments were passed on to the investigating officers. The information assisted the detectives which resulted in two people being arrested.

8.10.1.2 The release of photographic images or video recordings to the public including on Police social media sites must be coordinated by the CCN, Corporate Communications department.

8.10.1.3 The procedure for releasing images on police media sites is the same for the release of images on the traditional media. All images are first approved by the relevant commander of the LAC or specialist command, to protect police methodology. (Refer to JCF media policy)

8.10.1.4 Images and audio containing undercover operatives or their vehicles are pixelated or altered to hide their identity and are not released without approval from the Director, NIB.

8.10.1.5 The images are then reviewed by the JCF Counsel to ensure all images released are legally sound and will not breach the terms of warrants, jeopardise court proceedings or breach privacy legislation.

- 8.10.1.6 To use images that do not belong to the Police Force, such as CCTV, for non-investigative purposes, authorisation must be obtained from the owner(s) to avoid infringing copyright or intellectual property rights.

8.11 MODERATION OF POLICE SITES

8.11.1 The Moderator

8.11.1.1 Defamatory, Discriminatory or Offensive Public Comments

- i. Social media sites inevitably attract comments that are sometimes offensive, inappropriate or irrelevant. The JCF may be legally liable for defamatory postings on its social media sites where:
 - a) a person has requested the removal of a defamatory comment,
 - b) the Police Force ignores a defamatory comment on its site.
 - c) the defamatory matter is not removed after a reasonable time.
- ii. Failure to remove racially offensive, homophobic or other discriminatory comments may contravene antidiscrimination and defamatory legislations.
- iii. Where a person alleges that a comment is defamatory, discriminatory or offensive and requests its removal, the JCF must, as soon as reasonably possible, review and where necessary remove the content.

8.11.1.2 The Role of the Moderator

- i. All police social media sites that seek public comments on-line must have official moderators appointed to review comments either before or soon after they are posted. The role of the moderator is to ensure that on-line postings

placed on official JCF social media sites are relevant, non-threatening, respectful of the views of other contributor, and are not insulting, obscene or defamatory.

- ii. The moderator (s) must regularly review their social media site for activities and where necessary remove any postings that do not comply with the requirements, as set out in the Acceptable Use Standards **section 8.13**. A number of moderators may be appointed to ensure that postings are reviewed constantly throughout the day and night so as to avoid or reduce the potential of offensive or defamatory postings. In reviewing on-line postings:
 - a) The moderation process must assess all content on police social media sites, whether posted by JCF representatives or by members of the public.
 - b) The moderation process must be sensitive to the diversity of Jamaican public opinion and avoid any perception of discrimination or censorship.
 - c) The moderation process must be objective and impartial. Content that is positive or negative and in context is acceptable. Content that is insulting, obscene, offensive, discriminatory, denigrating or defamatory etc., **must be removed**.
 - d) For more serious or repeated breaches of this policy and JCF Media policy the moderator can ban members of the public from the police social media site.
 - e) When appropriate, the moderator may inform posters of reasons for the rejection of a post. The author of the rejected post may be given an opportunity to resubmit or repost an edited version of the former post.

8.11.1.3 Corporate Moderator

The Digital Media Coordinator of CCN will moderate the JCF's Corporate YouTube, Facebook, and Twitter sites during business hours. After business hours these sites are moderated by member(s) assigned by the Director Corporate

Communication and, are required to liaise with the on-call Senior Duty Officer.

8.12 COMPLAINTS

8.12.1 Customer Service Complaints

8.12.1.1 Citizens may use the JCF's official social media sites to make complaints and or commend members of the JCF on the service delivery.

8.12.1.2 In responding to customer service complaints, do not be defensive or take negative comments personally. Thank the person(s) for their feedback and remain professional and courteous. Consider the issue before responding. Do not speak on behalf of another Command or on topics outside your expertise without first seeking advice and authorization. Avoid making any statement that could be seen as criticising the JCF or Government policies.

8.12.1.3 Send a copy of the complaint to the relevant Commander for processing and advise the person making the post that it has been sent on for action to be taken.

8.12.2 Review of Complaints

8.12.2.1 When reviewing negative postings, the administrators and moderators of police social media sites must be able to identify when a criticism constitutes an actual complaint as opposed to a general grumble or a customer service issue. To be a complaint it must:

- i. Relate to the conduct of a police officer on or off duty,
- ii. State the Force's relevant policies on Ethics/ Integrity and Citizens Interaction Policy etc.

8.12.2.2 As a general rule, if a person nominates a specific incident and claims the police response was inappropriate or illegal, or if the actions of the Officer(s) were outside the Code of Conduct and Ethics, then the matter should be considered a complaint.

- 8.12.2.3 A reporting system should be put in place so that complaints posted on Police Force social media sites are captured and forwarded to the appropriate person or command.

8.13 ACCEPTABLE USE STANDARDS FOR SITE USERS

- 8.13.1 The aim of the acceptable use standards is to set standards that must be followed by members of the public when they contribute to police social media sites. The acceptable standards of usage help to create an environment where community members can contribute to investigations, the improvement of policy and or services, as well as the protection of the organisation from legal liability, without fear of abuse or harassment or exposure to offensive or otherwise inappropriate content.
- 8.13.2 All police social media sites that seek public comments on-line must have the following acceptable use standards displayed on the site:

“When contributing your views to this forum, please ensure that you:

- i. Protect your personal privacy and that of others, unless you are providing personal information to assist a police investigation or other request for advice from the public, by not including personal information of either yourself or of others in your posts to the forum (such as names, email addresses, private addresses or phone numbers)***
- ii. Post material to the forum that is relevant to the issues currently being discussed***
- iii. Represent your own views and not impersonate or falsely represent that of any other person or organization***
- iv. Do not post or upload any content that is unlawful, or may defame, libel or discriminate against others***
- v. Do not use obscene, offensive, indecent, insulting, provocative or hateful language, or harass or threaten others***

- vi. *Do not post material that encourages behaviour that may constitute a criminal offence or create a civil liability, or otherwise violate a law*
- vii. *Do not post material that is prejudicial or judgemental of individual(s) who have been arrested and charged, but who have not yet had the opportunity of defending themselves in court*
- viii. *Do not post material to the forum that infringes copyright, trademark or other intellectual property rights*
- ix. *Do not post multiple versions of the same view to the forum*
- x. *Do not promote commercial interests in your post to the forum; and*
- xi. *Do not include internet addresses or link to websites, or any email addresses, in your contribution unless you are providing information to assist a police investigation or other request for information from the public.*

8.14 EVALUATION

8.14.1 Assessment Effectiveness

8.14.1.1 On-going Evaluation

- i. An evaluation of police social media sites should be conducted every twelve months to ensure the site continues to be relevant to the mission of the JCF and is achieving its objectives.
- ii. The evaluation of social media sites should include analysis of:
 - a. success or failure measured against the agreed objectives of the sites;
 - b. time spent administering the site- cost in terms of the work loaded on staff members compared with the benefits;
 - c. the effectiveness of the administrators and moderators in managing the site;
 - d. extent to which two-way engagement is achieved;
 - e. quality of content posted by the JCF;
 - f. the quality and tone of comments posted by the public;

- g. Feedback from users- positive comments and complaints, problems or other negative experiences generated by the site, especially feedback that demonstrates whether the site or activity was successful or not in meeting the objectives.
- iii. The social media site will typically seek to achieve one or more of the following:
- a. **Awareness**-increase the awareness by the public of the JCF and events or incidents in the communities across Jamaica;
 - b. **Engagement**- foster community engagement with the agency;
 - c. **Influence**-influence community opinion and behaviour
 - d. **Action**- mobilise the public to take action (e.g. reporting crime(s) and assisting police).

8.15 DECOMMISSIONING

8.15.1 Closing down a site of Activity

8.15.1.1 When decommissioning any social media site or activity, consideration should be given to:

- i. reviewing which threads or comments should not and can or cannot be deleted;
- ii. managing the content and links to any other websites;
- iii. addressing any licenses or contracts associated with the site;
- iv. ability to successfully migrate any important content to other sites;
- v. ensuring that users are advised of the closure of the site or activity and;
- vi. compliance policies and processes of records management .

9.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

This policy and guidelines should be read in conjunction with the following

- 9.1 JCF Personal Use of Social Media Policy,
- 9.2 JCF Media Policy
- 9.3 JCF Ethics and Integrity Policy.
- 9.4 Cybercrimes Act 2015